

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 7 5 4

♥ 8 7 6

♦ 10

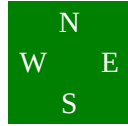
♣ A 8 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 8

♣ Q J 10



♠ 2

♥ A 10 3

♦ Q 9 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 10 8 6 3

♥ K 4 2

♦ K 4 3

♣ K 7 5

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points: - if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game. - if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game. Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she accepts the invitation.

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♦ 6

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 5 2

♥ 8 6 3

♦ K 10 9

♣ A 6 4

♠ 10 8 4

♥ K 7 2

♦ Q 6 5

♣ K J 9 3



♠ Q 3

♥ J 10 9 5

♦ 8 7 3 2

♣ 7 5 2

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q 10 8

With 9 points NORTH is unable to decide the final contract. If SOUTH has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If SOUTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So NORTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells SOUTH that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal SOUTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ J 10
♦ K Q 6 3
♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5



♠ J 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ Q 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4

This time NORTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

NORTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
2NT by North			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8

♥ Q

♦ K 10 9 8 6

♣ A Q 10 4

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 9 8 7 3



♠ 10 5 3

♥ K 9 7 6 4 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 6

♠ K Q 6

♥ A J 10 3

♦ A Q

♣ K J 5 2

SOUTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 2 points to SOUTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

All Pass

2NT by South

Lead: ♦ 10